an important factor in the way we see the world through the media. The journalists don't just report: their assumptions and their apathy have a part to play in making the picture that comes down to us. And we saw ourselves as journalists from the start. Better ones.

In the Internet Age, when so many people are driven into knowledge by their search engines, I knew the material would filter down anyhow. Even some military personnel themselves began visiting our site, to see what kind of replacement parts they might need for their vehicles. Irony of ironies: some NATO military contractor would appear in a chatroom saying can you help me find a wheel for my armoured vehicle. But the media sat back. I suppose we weren't yet an authoritative source, and we couldn't offer exclusivity – a thing that controls the whole universe of motivation in the media. Worst of all, the material we revealed was complex. But we had built a system that would alter the basic rules of journalism. With powerful organisations, such as the British Army, for instance, the Fourth Estate is used to looking at uniformed individuals and waiting for briefings, the journalist situating himself in a position of deference to an unregulated body of power. We forget there is real skin under those uniforms, and that is what we wanted to reveal, the naked truth under the disguises of power.

We had set off on a mission of grand witnessing. Computer technology was watchful, indeed, and was coupled, in our minds, with a burgeoning psychology of decency. I wrote a blog post at the time, trying to describe our motivations and our task. I wrote:

> *Every time we witness an injustice and do not act, we train our character to be passive in its presence and thereby lose all ability to defend ourselves and those we love. In a modern economy it is impossible to seal oneself off from injustice . . . If we can only live once, then let it be a daring adventure that draws on all our powers. Try as I may I cannot escape the sound of suffering. Perhaps as an old man I will take great comfort in pottering around in a lab and gently talking to students in the summer evening and will accept suffering with insouciance. But not now. Men in their prime, if they have convictions, are tasked to act on them.*